The World According to Toddlers

By Shannon Payette Seip and Adrienne Hedger

NARRATOR: (Pg vii – viii) *(cradling an infant in her arms)* In the beginning they are babies. Cue the soft music – *(sings)* Lullaby and goodnight . . . So cuddly. So sweet. Eating enthusiastically. Playing happily. Wearing the outfits you choose. Life is good! Then, around 18 months, the world starts to change. *(off-stage shriek– she wrestles with baby as it morphs into a toddler, finally lets it go)*

TODDLER: *(cross arms and says emphatically)* No! No! No! No!

NARRATOR: This is when you realize: Your baby is gone and in its place is a boisterous, opinionated human: Your toddler. NO!

INTRODUCTION

Welcome to the World According to Toddlers. A hilarious, messy (is hit in the face with a spoonful of something; wipes it off) and unpredictable universe.

The best way to navigate the toddler world? Nobody really knows . . . everyone just makes it up as they go along. It's a world where the human who believes he is the boss of you only comes up to your knee. A world where food must be cut just so. A world where throwing a spectacular tantrum is on the daily "TO DO" list (off-stage scream) Check!

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*******A Major Upset*******

NARRATOR: (Pg 8-9) It's a major upset – a tantrum is brewing. Let's cut to our commentators, Chuck and Judy, who are live on the scene to give us a play-by-play report

JUDY: Chuck, I sense Toddler is growing dissatisfied.

CHUCK: Well, look at those shoes Mom is asking her to wear. Tennis shoes with Velcro? That's outrageous!

JUDY: I think we're about to witness a full-blown tantrum. Let's watch the technique

TODDLER: *(crying interspersed with "No, no, no" and stomping feet)*

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JUDY: She's yelling something . . . I can't quite make it out.

CHUCK: Well, we can hear the word "no" for sure.

JUDY: She's making a move to throw herself to the ground. Wait . . . she's holding back on the sobbing while she concentrates on lowering herself to the ground . . . carefully.

CHUCK: The sobbing resumes, Judy! Watch that arm and leg movement. Impressive.

JUDY: Even more powerful than before.

TODDLER: *(full-blown tantrum mode – kicking and flailing)*

JUDY: Chuck, everything is infuriating to her now. Even air.

CHUCK: She's punching the air! I would not want to be that air right now. And listen to that scream!

TODDLER: *(manages to get one shoe off and throws it viciously)*

JUDY: This kid knows her stuff.

CHUCK: Well, she's had practice, Judy. Plenty of practice.

******** Snack Time *******

NARRATOR: **(Pg 21)** A juice box chilled at exactly 37 degrees. Hexagonal wheat crackers, arranged in a fan. Green grapes that are perfectly oblong. No, it's not a superstar's dressing room requirements: it's the high-maintenance demands of a toddler. [It's] **(Pg 34-35)** Snack Time!

JUDY: Chuck, Toddler wants a banana.

CHUCK: Mom has the banana in hand. He's watching for a sign that it's OK to peel.

TODDLER: *(raising arms and opening and closing fists rapidly, with a low-pitched whine)*

JUDY: There's the sign!

CHUCK: Peeling is underway. She needs to keep this slow and controlled so she can stop at exactly the right point.

JUDY: Chuck, if she peels even a centimeter too much, that banana is ruined. I think we all remember what happened last week, when she pulled the granola bar wrapper down too far.

CHUCK: And let's not forget the incident with the string cheese wrapper.

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JUDY: What about the time Dad handed Toddler a naked banana? *(Gasp!)*

CHUCK: I think we're getting close . . . close.

MOM: *(peeling a banana like she's diffusing a bomb)*

CHUCK: She's stopping!

TODDLER: *(stops screaming suddenly, takes the banana and munches on it)*

JUDY: Whew! Right at the perfect point!

*******The Social Lives of Toddlers*******

NARRATOR: **(Pg 41)** Peeing in the sandbox. Though this violation might offend an adult during a social gathering, it's commonly accepted during a toddler's playdate. No feelings hurt. No friendships destroyed. Let's take an inside look at how toddlers play, share (yeah, right!) and enjoy the company of others. Come hope in the sandbox! *(pointing)* Just watch out for that wet spot.

(Pg 54) [It's just your average] playdate at the park! **(Pg 94)** Don't forget your blankie, stuffed giraffe, pacifier, snack, pillow, another snack and your favorite socks! **(Pg 100)** [But] Understand this: You do not need a stroller. Your mom thinks you still need one, but she is dead wrong!

TODDLER: *(wandering in, clutching all these items in her arms)*

CHUCK: **(Pg 54)** Whoa! Judy, I think she's just going to stand next to that tree, holding her treasured toys.

JUDY: Here comes Toddler's friend to say hi. Here comes another!

TODDLER 2: **(Pg 50)** Do you want to play with me?

TODDLER: *(turns away violently shaking her head)*

CHUCK: **(Pg 54-55)** She's got a pretty hostile look on her face. That little head is vehemently shaking no.

JUDY: Mom is encouraging Toddler to play.

CHUCK: She can't be serious, Judy. Doesn't she know that those kids will just steal Toddler's best toys?

JUDY: That's right, Chuck. The point of bringing your toys to the park is to make sure no

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one else gets them.

TODDLER: (Pg 67) No, no, no, no!

JUDY: This powerful word is appropriate at any time, in any setting . . .

CHUCK: (Pg 55 Yes! Her plan is to hold tight and not move for the entire 90-minute playdate.

JUDY: It's too risky to even play with your things or other kids might want to play too.

CHUCK: All you can do is show up and guard your stuff.

JUDY: Guard it with your life, Chuck. With your life!

TODDLER: (Pg 66) Mommmmmmmy!

JUDY: Hungry, tired, uncomfortable, or bored? Yelling MOMMY is the remedy!

******** Night Night ********

NARRATOR: (Pg 136-137) Dear Katie, Thank you for babysitting for us tonight. Here are some notes about putting Bobby to bed. Best of luck!

Bobby needs to be situated at a 30 degree angle to the door with his yellow blanket (light yellow, not dark yellow) covering him just up to his chest – one-half centimeter lower than his armpits. Now sing the ABC song to him.

KATIE: *(singing)* A, B, C, D, E, F, G . . .

NARRATOR: In a British accent!

KATIE: A, B, C, D, E, F, G . . .

NARRATOR: When ABC concludes, sing "Twinkle Twinkle Little Star" until he falls asleep or until we get home.

KATIE: *(singing)* Twinkle Twinkle Little Star

NARRATOR: Thank you! We'll be home VERY late. *(evil, giddy laughter)*

TODDLER: (Pg 139) [Dear Magic Eight Ball], I don't want to sleep and I'm tired of crying it out. Should I throw up? *(shakes magic eight ball)*

MAGIC EIGHT BALL: Crying takes too much energy; it's more effective and expedient to throw up. Chances are very good that "night-night time" will be all done.

TODDLER: *(smiles evilly)*

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KATIE: *(singing)* . . . How I wonder where you are *(continues singing through Toddler's mime)*

TODDLER: *(throws up)* (**Pg 17)** Gotta go potty! *(makes a grimacing face)* It's coming out! *(pooping his pants. A contented sigh, then stuttering)* **(Pg 62)** You know wha. . You know wha. . . You know wha . . . **(Pg 20)** I DO IT! I DO IT!

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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